Michael Wacha

RHP · KC

2026 · 32 G (32 GS) · 3,028 pitches · Mar 28 – Sep 26, 2026

Independent portfolio sample by Devin Jenkinson, not affiliated with any club. Every number is computed from public Statcast data.

THREE BIG TAKEAWAYS

1 — ATTACK

The changeup is the put-away pitch. Use it to finish at-bats.

33% of two-strike pitches · 27% whiffs/swing (194 swings)

It grades 114 Stuff+. Next best two-strike miss rate: the 4-seam fastball at 19%.

2 — AVOID

Limit the sinker. It is his most damaging pitch.

xRV/100 -0.80 shrunk (raw -1.36) · .404 xwOBAcon · 413 pitches

When behind in the count he throws it 20% of the time; the changeup grades +1.47 there instead.

3 — WATCH

After the changeup, hitters chase the 4-seam fastball most.

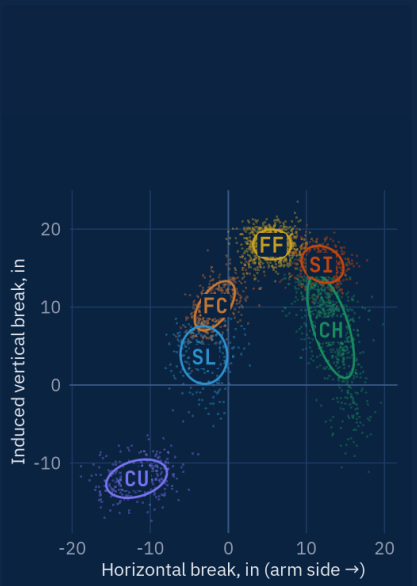
31% chased on 391 out-of-zone pitches

Fastball height splits are too thin to call (272 swings up, 44 down).

CHARTS

MOVEMENT

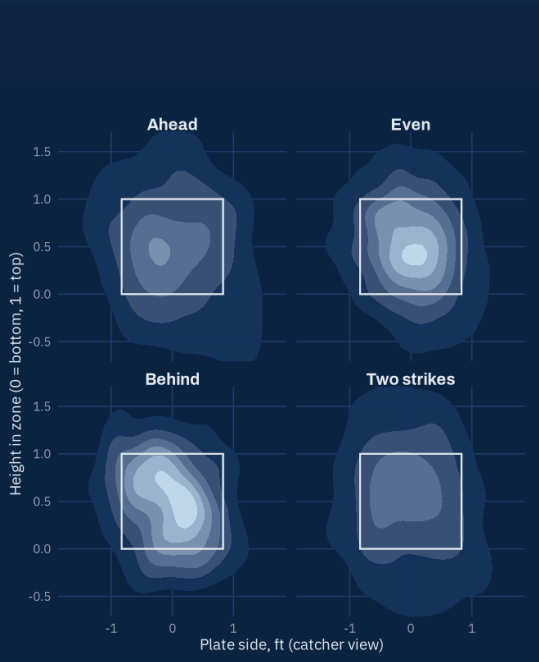
The CU finishes 35 in from his FF, with 30 in less rise.



n = 3,028 pitches. Ellipses hold about 68% of each type; codes sit at the averages.

LOCATION BY COUNT

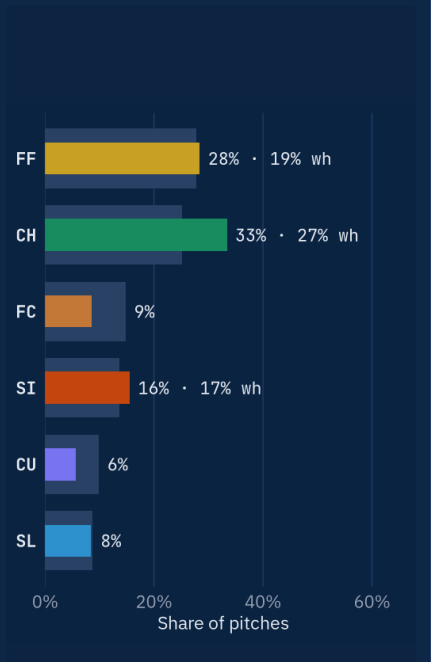
He throws 61% of pitches in the zone when behind and 42% when ahead.



n = 3,028. Ahead 405 · even 1114 · behind 590 · two strikes 919 pitches. Box = rule-book zone.

PUT-AWAY

The CH is 33% of two-strike pitches vs 25% overall.



Two-strike n: CH 307, FF 261, SI 143, FC 79, SL 77, CU 52. Grey bars = overall usage; wh = whiffs per swing (shown with 50+ swings).

ARSENAL

Pitch	#	Use	Velo	IVB	HB	VAA	Whiff	Chase	xwOBAcon	xRV/100	Stuff+
4-Seam (FF)	840	28%	93.2	18.0	+5.6	-5.3	20%	31%	.389	-0.05	97
Changeup (CH)	762	25%	80.6	7.1	+13.2	-8.4	28%	38%	.271	+1.47	114
Cutter (FC)	449	15%	89.5	10.2	-1.6	-6.6	14%	25%	.365	+0.63	100
Sinker (SI)	413	14%	93.2	15.5	+11.9	-5.9	13%	25%	.404	-0.80	86
Curveball (CU)	301	10%	75.9	-12.0	-11.7	-10.6	26%	21%	.369	-0.76	93
Slider (SL)	263	9%	85.0	3.6	-3.1	-8.3	30%	28%	.349	-0.27	100

IVB / HB in inches (HB + = arm side). VAA in degrees at the front of the plate. xRV/100 = expected run value per 100 pitches, pitcher's view, shrunk with a 250-pitch prior. Stuff+ = this project's shape-only model (100 = MLB average, 10 = 1 SD).

VS. BATTER HAND

Pitch	LHH #	Use	Whiff	xwOBAcon	RHH #	Use	Whiff	xwOBAcon
FF	562	31%	21%	.358	278	23%	20%	.286
CH	594	33%	29%	.225	168	14%	24%	.224
FC	280	16%	14%	.282	169	14%	15%	.465
SI	134	7%	16%	.289	279	23%	11%	.435
CU	187	10%	24%	.360	114	9%	–	.278
SL	37	2%	–	.305	226	18%	32%	.299

Use = share of pitches to that side. Whiff = whiffs per swing, shown with 50+ swings.

Source: Baseball Savant Statcast search (public pitch-level data, 2026 regular season), processed with DuckDB SQL + R (xgboost). Independent portfolio sample, not produced by or affiliated with any MLB club.